

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 5 2
♥ Q 7
♦ J 10 5 2
♣ A K 9 4

♠ A K 9 8 6 4

♥ 8 6 3

♦ A 7

♣ 7 3



♠ 10 3
♥ K 10 5 2
♦ Q 9 6
♣ J 10 8 2

♠ Q J

♥ A J 9 4

♦ K 8 4 3

♣ Q 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You ruff the third ♣, then play ♠ Q and ♠ J. Come to your hand with the ♦ A and pull the last trump. Now decide what to do with the ♥ s.

If East has both ♥ K and ♥ Q then a simple finesse of the ♥ J will bring in the contract. This is only a 25% chance.

If the high ♥ honors are split, but East holds the ♥ 10 then a finesse of the ♥ 9 will force West to win with his high honor. You can return to your hand and then finesse East out of his other ♥ honor. This play has about a 50% chance of working so it is the one you should make.

This is called a Deep Finesse.

The only time it is a mistake is when East holds the ♥ K Q and West holds the ♥ 10. Even in that case though some Wests will "split their honors" and give it away.

Two choices come to mind - 2NT or 2♥.

Of the two, 2♥ is better because it prevents a possible 4-4 ♥ fit from being lost. Partner rebids his ♠ s.

Two opening hands equal one game. Since partner has 6 ♠ that game might as well be 4 ♠.

South would play 4 ♠.

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North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♣ J. They play two more high ♣ s.

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Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 2
♥ Q 10 4
♦ 10 9 6 5 3
♣ A Q 7

♠ J 10 7 4

♥ 7 3

♦ K Q 8 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ K Q 5

♥ K J 9 8 5

♦ A 7

♣ K 8 6

♠ A 9 8 3

♥ A 6 2

♦ J 4

♣ J 10 9 2

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♣	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East

the same invitational quality to it, but it will give partner the information about where you could use some help. This is called a Help Suit Game Try. In this case you bid 3♣.

Partner, with 9 points and help for ♣s, bids 4♥.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♣J.

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Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

The ♠A and the ♥A definitely won't go away. And the ♦ loser is pretty sure also. However, the second ♠ loser can be eliminated either by leading up to the ♠ K Q 5 or by ruffing it in dummy.

Suppose you win the ♣ and play one round of trumps. Oops, it is now too late to make the contract. Someone can win the ♥A and play another ♥. Then, whoever takes the ♠A can lead a third ♥ and you can no longer ruff your ♠.

Try this instead. Win the ♣ in dummy and play a small ♠ to your ♠Q. Assume South wins the ♠A and leads ♥A and another ♥. You win this in your hand, play ♠K and ruff your last ♠ with dummy's last trump. Now get to your hand, pull trumps and give up a ♦ at the end.

Leading even one round of trumps would be a mistake.

Suppose when you led toward your ♠Q it held the trick. Would you be convinced that North musthold the ♠A and change your plan? Would you then pull trumps and let your contract depend on that assumption? I hope not.

You have a valid opening 1NT bid. You also have a valid opening 1♥ bid. It is up to you and your partner to agree on whether you will open 1NT when you hold a 5-card Major.

For the purpose of this Deal, and not choosing sides, you open 1♥. Partner responds 2♥.

You agree on Where, now you must figure out How High. Add partner's 6-10 to your 17 and you get 23-27. In other words you might have enough for game if partner has a maximum.

You want to make an invitational bid and it is ok to now bid 3♥. Partner will understand what you mean and will either pass or bid 4♥, depending on his hand.

But you can also bid any other suit and it will have